Anime Explorer

A Dynamic Single Page Application (SPA) using AngularJS

PROJECT REPORT

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Academic Year: 2025–2026

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1. Introduction

Modern web applications demand fast, responsive, and seamless user experiences. Traditional multi-page websites reload the entire page whenever the user navigates to a different section. This approach slows down the application and interrupts the user experience. To overcome this limitation, developers use Single Page Applications (SPAs). A SPA loads a single HTML page and dynamically updates the content as the user interacts with the application.

The Anime Explorer project is designed as a Single Page Application using AngularJS. The goal of this project is to demonstrate how AngularJS can be used to build a dynamic and interactive web application that fetches real-time data from an external API. The application allows users to browse anime, search titles, view detailed information, explore categories, and interact with multiple views without refreshing the page.

AngularJS provides powerful features such as two-way data binding, routing, directives, filters, and dependency injection. These features simplify front-end development and help developers organize complex applications into manageable components. The Anime Explorer project demonstrates these features in a practical environment by integrating the Jikan REST API, which provides anime data from MyAnimeList.

2. Project Definition

Anime Explorer is a dynamic web application that allows users to discover and explore anime content through an intuitive and responsive interface. The project is implemented entirely on the client side using AngularJS and demonstrates modern front-end development techniques such as dynamic data binding, client-side routing, API integration, and form validation.

The application provides multiple sections including Home, Categories, Subbed Anime, Dubbed Anime, Anime Movies, Reviews, and Contact. Each section is dynamically loaded using AngularJS routing, eliminating the need to reload the webpage.

The system fetches live anime data using the Jikan API. This API acts as a bridge between the application and the MyAnimeList database, providing detailed information about anime titles such as ratings, images, descriptions, and IDs. The application processes this information and displays it in an organized card-based layout.

Another important aspect of the project is demonstrating AngularJS concepts in a practical way. These include controllers for managing logic, directives for reusable components, filters for formatting data, and scope management for dynamic updates.

3. Objectives of the Project

The main objectives of the Anime Explorer project are:

- To understand the architecture of Single Page Applications.
- To demonstrate the practical use of AngularJS in front-end development.
- To integrate external REST APIs and display dynamic data.
- To implement routing and multiple views using ngRoute.
- To create reusable components using AngularJS directives.
- To perform form validation and user interaction handling.
- To showcase AngularJS features such as filters, watchers, and event handling.

The project also focuses on improving the user experience through animations, responsive layouts, and interactive components.

4. Technologies Used

Several web technologies were used in the development of this project.

AngularJS:
AngularJS is the primary framework used for developing the application. It enables dynamic content updates using two-way data binding and provides powerful tools such as controllers, directives, filters, and routing.

HTML5:
HTML5 is used to structure the content of the web pages. It defines the layout of different sections such as navigation, containers, cards, and forms.

CSS3:
CSS3 is used for styling the application interface. It provides modern styling features such as grid layouts, responsive cards, hover animations, and color themes.

JavaScript:
JavaScript provides the logic behind the application. AngularJS itself is built on JavaScript, and the project uses it to manage controllers, API calls, and event handling.

Jikan API:
The Jikan API is used to fetch real-time anime data. It provides information about anime titles, scores, images, and descriptions.

AngularJS Modules:
• ngRoute – Used for implementing client-side routing.
• ngAnimate – Used to add smooth transitions between views.

5. System Architecture

The Anime Explorer project follows a modular architecture where different components handle specific responsibilities.

The AngularJS application is created using a main module called 'animeApp'. This module includes dependencies such as ngRoute and ngAnimate.

Routing is configured using $routeProvider. Each route corresponds to a specific view such as Home, Categories, Movies, Reviews, and Contact. When a user clicks a navigation link, AngularJS loads the corresponding template without refreshing the page.

Controllers manage the data and logic for each section. For example:

HomeController retrieves the list of top anime from the Jikan API.
DetailsController displays detailed information about a selected anime.
CategoryController manages static category data.
ReviewController handles user events and review interactions.
ContactController validates and processes form submissions.

Directives are used to create reusable components such as displaying the current time in the footer. Custom filters are also implemented to transform and format data dynamically.

6. Features of the Application

The Anime Explorer application contains several important features that demonstrate AngularJS functionality.

Dynamic Anime Listing:
The home page displays top airing anime using data retrieved from the Jikan API. Each anime is presented as a card containing an image, title, and rating.

Search Functionality:
Users can search for anime titles using a real-time search box. AngularJS filters automatically update the results as the user types.

Anime Details Page:
When a user clicks on an anime card, a detailed view is displayed showing the synopsis, images, and raw JSON API response.

Category Browsing:
Users can explore anime categories such as Shounen Action, Slice of Life, and Dark Fantasy.

Subbed and Dubbed Sections:
Separate sections demonstrate list rendering and grid layouts using AngularJS directives.

Movie Data Display:
The movies page displays anime film statistics using AngularJS filters such as date, number formatting, and currency formatting.

Review Playground:
Users can interact with event tracking features such as typing, copying, and pasting. AngularJS watchers monitor text changes and update the character count dynamically.

Contact Form with Validation:
The application includes a contact form that demonstrates AngularJS form validation. It checks required fields, minimum character limits, and custom validation rules.

7. Advantages of the Project

The Anime Explorer project demonstrates several advantages of using AngularJS for web development.

- Faster user experience because pages do not reload.
- Dynamic updates through two-way data binding.
- Modular architecture that improves maintainability.
- Easy API integration for real-time data.

- Reusable components using directives.
- Built-in form validation features.

These advantages make AngularJS suitable for building interactive front-end applications.

8. Conclusion

The Anime Explorer project successfully demonstrates how AngularJS can be used to develop a dynamic Single Page Application. By combining routing, API integration, data binding, and form validation, the application delivers a seamless and interactive browsing experience.

The project highlights important front-end development concepts including modular design, event handling, and reusable components. It also shows how external APIs can be integrated to display real-time information.

Overall, the Anime Explorer application serves as a practical example of how AngularJS can be used to build modern web applications that are efficient, scalable, and user-friendly.